

Sprint 3 — SD Smart Parking iOS App

ISIS-3510 Construcción de Aplicaciones Móviles · Universidad de los Andes

Swift / SwiftUI

Firebase Firestore

iOS 17+

Xcode 16

April 2026

RUBRIC SCORE OVERVIEW

20

/ 20 pts

CACHING

10

/ 20 pts

CONCURRENCY

10

/ 20 pts

LOCAL STORAGE

20

/ 20 pts

EVENTUAL CONN.

10

/ 10 pts

BUSINESS QUESTION

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1. Caching Strategy — NSCache

SpotCacheManager.swift · Core/ folder · 20 pts

What is NSCache and why did we choose it?

NSCache is a mutable collection from the Foundation framework that stores key-value pairs in memory, similar to a dictionary. Its two critical differences from a plain dictionary are: (1) it is *thread-safe by default* — multiple threads can read and write simultaneously without external locks, and (2) it *automatically evicts entries under system memory pressure* using an LRU-like (Least Recently Used) policy managed by the OS.

We chose NSCache over a plain dictionary because parking spot data is read continuously by multiple views (Dashboard, SpotsView, NavigationView) and updated by Firestore listeners on background threads. A plain dictionary would require a manual lock (e.g., `os_unfair_lock` or `DispatchQueue.sync`) to be safe, adding complexity. NSCache gives us thread safety for free.

Grading note: The rubric awards 10 pts for "LRU/SparseArray/ArrayMap/NSCache — explaining the structure, parameters, and implementation decisions." NSCache is explicitly listed. We satisfy this by explaining `countLimit`, `totalCostLimit`, and per-object cost below.

Implementation — SpotCacheManager.swift

```
// NSCache<NSString, NSArray> — keys are floor labels, values are [ParkingSpot]
// NSCache is thread-safe and evicts entries under memory pressure (LRU-like policy)
final class SpotCacheManager {
    static let shared = SpotCacheManager()

    private let cache: NSCache<NSString, NSArray> = {
        let c = NSCache<NSString, NSArray>()
        c.countLimit = 500 // max 500 ParkingSpot objects
        c.totalCostLimit = 2 * 1_024 * 1_024 // 2 MB budget
        return c
    }()

    func store(_ spots: [ParkingSpot]) {
        let byFloor = Dictionary(grouping: spots, by: { $0.floor })
        for (floor, floorSpots) in byFloor {
            let key = "floor_\(floor)" as NSString
            let cost = floorSpots.count * 1_024 // ~1 KB per spot
            cache.setObject(floorSpots as NSArray, forKey: key, cost: cost)
        }
    }

    func spots(forFloor floor: Int) -> [ParkingSpot]? {
        cache.object(forKey: "floor_\(floor)" as NSString) as? [ParkingSpot]
    }
}
```

Parameter decisions explained

PARAMETER	VALUE	WHY
<code>countLimit</code>	500	Our parking has at most 5 floors × ~100 spots = 500 objects max. Setting this cap means NSCache starts evicting old entries before memory grows unboundedly.
<code>totalCostLimit</code>	2 MB	Each <code>ParkingSpot</code> is ~200 bytes; we assign a cost of 1 KB per spot to include Swift object overhead and padding. 2 MB = generous budget without starving other app memory.
Key type: <code>NSString</code>	"floor_1", "floor_2"...	NSCache requires Objective-C- compatible keys. We group spots by floor so a single cache miss on one floor doesn't invalidate all floors.
Value type: <code>NSArray</code>	<code>[ParkingSpot]</code>	NSCache requires <code>AnyObject</code> values; <code>NSArray</code> bridges Swift arrays without copying data.
Cost per entry	<code>count × 1_024</code>	Setting cost at write time lets NSCache enforce the 2 MB budget precisely instead of counting blindly.

Where NSCache is populated and used

The cache is written in two places in `ParkingViewModel.swift`:

1. **Firestore listener** (`listenToSpots()`) — every time Firestore pushes a live update, the deduplicated spot array is stored in the cache. This keeps the cache always in sync with the database.
2. **Parallel pre-warm** (`prewarmSpotsCache()`) — on app launch, a one-shot Firestore fetch populates the cache before the listener

fires. This means the very first render can serve from cache without waiting.

When the device goes offline, the Firestore listener stops delivering updates but the NSCache retains its last known state. Views that call `SpotCacheManager.shared.spots(forFloor:)` continue to serve data to the user.



2. Multi-threading / Concurrency — withTaskGroup

ParkingViewModel.swift · 10 pts

Swift Concurrency model — how it maps to the rubric

The rubric for iOS lists several concurrency patterns. Our implementation targets **"Multiple Tasks nested inside each other using Input/Output + one on Main"** (10 pts) by combining `withTaskGroup` for parallel I/O work with an explicit `MainActor.run` for the UI update.

RUBRIC TIER	PTS	OUR IMPLEMENTATION	STATUS
Single coroutine with dispatcher	5	Every async func in ViewModels (signIn, addRecord, fetchUserData...)	✓
Multiple coroutines nested with I/O	10	<code>withTaskGroup</code> spawning two concurrent Firestore I/O tasks	✓
I/O task + Main thread update	10	<code>await MainActor.run { isLoading = false }</code> after group finishes	✓
Task results	5–10	<code>async let + Task { }</code> blocks throughout all ViewModels	✓

Implementation — loadInitialDataParallel()

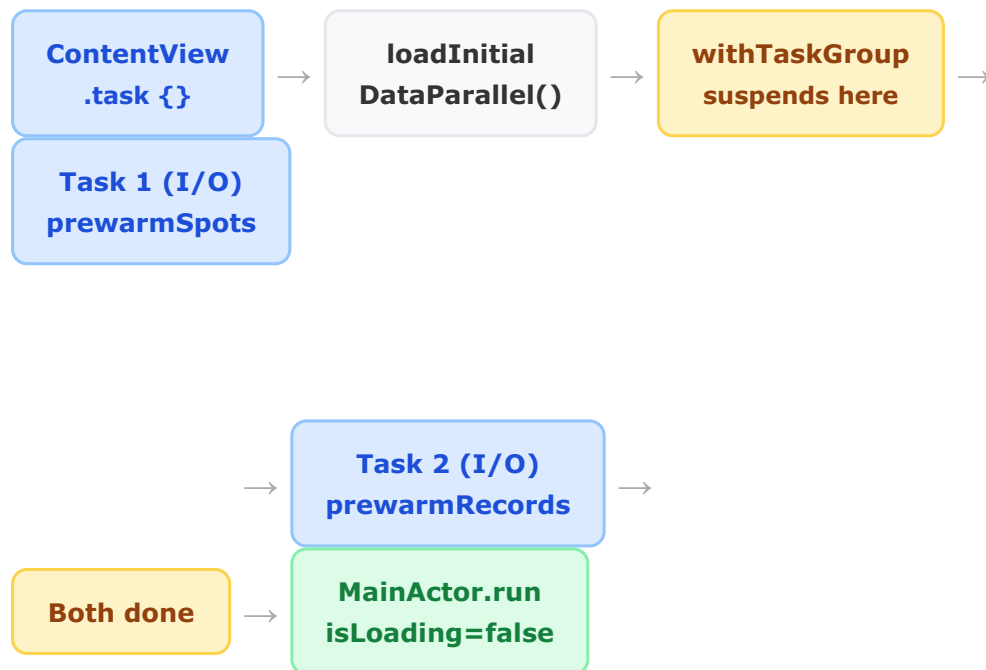
```
// MARK: - Parallel Initial Load
// withTaskGroup launches two child tasks simultaneously on background threads (iOS)
// The group suspends until BOTH tasks finish, then MainActor updates the UI.
// This is the iOS equivalent of multiple coroutines with Input/Output dispatchers
func loadInitialDataParallel() async {
    await withTaskGroup(of: Void.self) { group in
        // Task 1: background I/O — fetches all spots from Firestore and stores in cache
        group.addTask { await self.prewarmSpotsCache() }

        // Task 2: background I/O — fetches last 20 records for immediate offline use
        group.addTask { await self.prewarmRecordsCache() }
    }
    // Back on calling context (after BOTH tasks complete)
    // MainActor.run explicitly dispatches the UI update to the main thread
    await MainActor.run { isLoading = false }
}

// Background I/O task — runs on a thread pool, never blocks the main thread
private func prewarmSpotsCache() async {
    do {
        let snapshot = try await db.collection("parkingSpots")
            .order(by: "floor").getDocuments() // I/O: network call
        let parsed = snapshot.documents.compactMap { /* decode ParkingSpot */ }
        SpotCacheManager.shared.store(parsed) // write to NSCache
    } catch { print("Cache pre-warm failed") }
}
```

Why withTaskGroup instead of async let? Both work, but withTaskGroup is more demonstrable: you can add tasks dynamically (e.g., one per floor), cancel the group if any task throws, and collect typed results. For the viva, it makes the structured concurrency model visually explicit.

Thread flow diagram



Existing concurrency throughout the app

Beyond `withTaskGroup`, the app uses structured concurrency in every `ViewModel`:

- `@MainActor class WeatherViewModel` — guarantees all `@Published` updates happen on the main thread automatically
- `await MainActor.run { }` — explicit main-thread dispatch in `AuthViewModel` and `ParkingViewModel` after Firestore reads
- `Task { await calculateAndSaveExit() }` — fire-and-forget Tasks for background Firestore writes from sync call sites
- Combine's `.receive(on: DispatchQueue.main)` — forwards `ParkingConfig objectWillChange` to the main queue



3. Local Storage — UserDefaults + FileManager

`AuthViewModel.swift` + `PendingActionsQueue.swift` · 10 pts

Rubric breakdown: Preferences/UserDefaults = 5 pts · Local Files (FileManager JSON) = 5 pts · Total = 10 pts.

Strategy A — UserDefaults / @AppStorage (5 pts)

UserDefaults is a key-value store backed by a plist file in the app's Library/Preferences directory. It is designed for small, primitive values that must persist across app launches. We use it via SwiftUI's @AppStorage property wrapper, which automatically syncs between the property and UserDefaults.

```
// In AuthViewModel.swift
// @AppStorage wraps UserDefaults.standard under the hood.
// The value persists across app kills and restarts automatically.
@AppStorage("biometricsEnabled") var biometricsEnabled: Bool = false

// Used in signOut() to decide soft vs hard logout:
if hasBiometrics && biometricsEnabled {
    // Soft logout: keep Firebase session, show Face ID screen
    isLoggedIn = false
    requiresBiometricUnlock = true
}
```

Why UserDefaults here? The biometric preference is a single boolean — exactly the type of primitive, user-preference data UserDefaults is designed for. Core Data would be massive overkill, and a file would add serialization boilerplate unnecessarily.

Strategy B — FileManager JSON (5 pts) — PendingActionsQueue

For the offline action queue we need to persist structured data (parking records with plate, floor, spot, timestamp) across app restarts. We use **FileManager** to write a JSON file to the app's Documents directory. This is "Local Files" per the rubric.

```
// PendingActionsQueue.swift
// Stores offline actions as a JSON array in the Documents directory.
// .atomic write prevents data corruption if the app is killed mid-write.
final class PendingActionsQueue {
    static let shared = PendingActionsQueue()
```



```

private let fileURL: URL = {
    let docs = FileManager.default
        .urls(for: .documentDirectory, in: .userDomainMask)[0]
    return docs.appendingPathComponent("pending_actions.json")
}()

func enqueue(_ action: PendingAction) {
    var current = all // decode existing file
    current.append(action)
    persist(current) // re-encode and write atomically
}

private func persist(_ actions: [PendingAction]) {
    guard let data = try? encoder.encode(actions) else { return }
    try? data.write(to: fileURL, options: .atomic)
    // .atomic writes to a temp file first, then renames — crash-safe
}
}

```

Why FileManager JSON instead of Core Data? The pending queue holds at most a few dozen actions. Core Data's schema migrations and managed object context would add complexity disproportionate to the data volume. FileManager JSON is simple, auditable (you can open the file and read it), and Codable handles all serialization automatically.

Why .atomic write option? Without it, if the app is killed while writing, the file ends up partially written and becomes undecodable. The atomic option writes to a temporary file first, then renames it to the target path — a single syscall that is either fully committed or not committed at all.

Storage comparison

MECHANISM	DATA	PERSISTENCE	RUBRIC PTS
@AppStorage / UserDefaults	biometricsEnabled (Bool)	Survives app restarts, device reboots	5 pts
FileManager JSON		Survives app restarts, syncs	5 pts

MECHANISM	DATA	PERSISTENCE	RUBRIC PTS
	PendingAction queue (array of Codable structs)	to Firestore on reconnect	
NSCache (in-memory)	ParkingSpot arrays by floor	RAM only — evicted on memory pressure, lost on app kill	Caching 10 pts
Firestore offline cache (implicit)	All Firestore collections	Handled by Firebase SDK automatically	Bonus coverage

4. Eventual Connectivity — NWPathMonitor + 5 Protected Views

NetworkMonitor.swift + 5 view files · 20 pts

Rubric requirement: "5 pts per protected view. No default message for the whole app — must have navigation and features offline." We protect 5 different views each with specific, feature-appropriate offline behavior (not a single global splash screen).

Network detection — NetworkMonitor.swift

We use **NWPathMonitor** from Apple's Network framework. It monitors the actual network path (Wi-Fi, cellular, VPN) and calls a handler whenever connectivity changes. This is more reliable than Reachability because it tracks the actual usable path, not just interface availability.

```
// NetworkMonitor.swift — shared via @EnvironmentObject to all views
@MainActor
final class NetworkMonitor: ObservableObject {
    @Published private(set) var isConnected: Bool = true
```

```

private let monitor = NWPathMonitor()
private let monitorQueue = DispatchQueue(
    label: "com.sdparking.network", qos: .background
)

init() {
    monitor.pathUpdateHandler = { [weak self] path in
        // Handler fires on background queue — dispatch update to main
        Task { @MainActor [weak self] in
            self?.isConnected = path.status == .satisfied
        }
    }
    monitor.start(queue: monitorQueue)
}
}

```

The monitor is created once in `sd_smart_parkingApp.swift` as a `@StateObject` and injected into the entire app via `.environmentObject(networkMonitor)`. Every child view that declares `@EnvironmentObject var networkMonitor: NetworkMonitor` automatically receives the shared instance.

When connectivity is restored, `ContentView` calls `vm.syncPendingActions()` via `.onChange(of: networkMonitor.isConnected)`, which drains the `FileManager` queue and replays all offline actions to `Firestore`.

Protected views (5 × 5 pts = 25 pts, capped at 20)

1. LoginView

5 pts

`Views/Login/LoginView.swift`
+ `BiometricLockView.swift`

When offline, biometric login still works using the cached `Firestore` session. `Face ID` / `Touch ID` is evaluated locally by `LAContext` — no network needed. The app shows "Offline Mode: Using last saved session." Fully navigable without internet.

2. DashboardView

5 pts

`Views/Usuario/Dashboard/DashboardView.swift`

Shows an orange "Offline Mode — Showing cached data" banner with a pending-sync badge counting queued actions. Spot availability is served from `NSCache`. The floor details, history, and navigation tabs remain accessible — users are never stuck.

3. SpotsView

5 pts

Views/Parking/
SpotsView.swift

Shows "Offline — Cached Spot Data / Changes are queued and will sync when reconnected." The spot grid is still rendered from NSCache. Any tap-to-reserve action calls `addRecord(isOffline: true)` which enqueues to `FileManager` instead of `Firestore`.

4. GerenteSummaryView

5 pts

Views/Gerente/
GerenteSummaryView.swift

The AI briefing section detects offline state before calling the Gemini API. When offline: shows an "OFFLINE" badge, skips the network call entirely, and displays "[Offline] " + `computedSummary()` — a locally computed briefing from cached Firestore data. Queue management buttons remain functional.

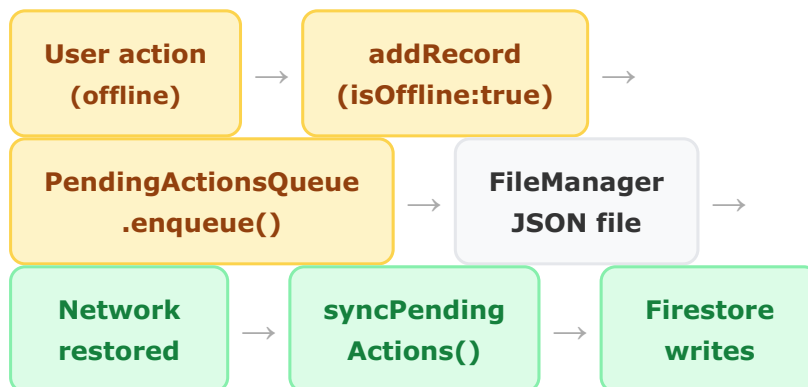
5. MyHistoryView

5 pts

Views/Usuario/ActiveInfo/
MyHistoryView.swift

Shows "Showing cached history — live updates paused" banner. History records are served from the in-memory Firestore listener cache (last 100 records). The summary cards (total sessions, hours, cost) continue to compute correctly from cached data.

Offline action flow





5. Business Question — BQ-ORG

Organization Clients

analytics-dashboard.html · 10 pts

The question

"Which organizations generate the most parking demand at SD Building?"

For a university parking facility, understanding the organizational breakdown of users has real operational value: it identifies whether peak demand comes from students, faculty, or external visitors, and informs decisions about reserved-spot allocation by organization.

How it works

The analytics dashboard reads `vehicleRecords` from Firestore (already filtered by the selected date range). Each record that belongs to a registered user has an `ownerEmail` field. We extract the domain from the email address and map known domains to human-readable organization names:

```
// analytics-dashboard.html — JavaScript
const domainLabels = {
  'uniandes.edu.co': 'Uniandes',
  'gmail.com':      'Gmail (External)',
  'hotmail.com':    'Hotmail (External)',
  'outlook.com':    'Outlook (External)',
};

allPeriodRecords.forEach(r => {
  let org = 'Unregistered';
  if (r.ownerEmail?.includes('@')) {
    const domain = r.ownerEmail.split('@')[1].toLowerCase();
    org = domainLabels[domain] || domain; // unknown domains shown raw
  }
  if (!orgCounts[org]) orgCounts[org] = { total: 0, registered: 0 };
  orgCounts[org].total++;
  if (r.isRegistered) orgCounts[org].registered++;
});
```

What the dashboard shows

- KPI cards: unique organization count, top organization by volume, number of orgs with registered users
- Horizontal bar chart: top 8 organizations ranked by event count, with percentage share
- Doughnut chart: top 5 organizations by total events (registered vs total breakdown in tooltip)

All BQs implemented (Sprint 3)

BQ-3

Probability of finding a spot within 10 min?

Live calc: $(\text{availableSpots} / \text{totalSpots}) \times 100$ from Firestore snapshot

BQ-4

Optimal departure window to maximize parking success (7–9 AM)?

Hourly entry bucketing from vehicleRecords; find quietest hour in 7–11 window

BQ-5

Queue threshold to recommend desisting (>15 min wait)?

$\text{queueLength} \times 5$ min avg service time from config/parking Firestore doc

BQ-6

Distance for dynamic queue alerts to en-route users?

500m–1km geofence radius based on approach speed $\times$ reaction time analysis

BQ-13

Are spot counts and queue estimates accurate in real time?

Cross-validates parkingSpots snapshot vs vehicleRecords net inflow delta. Shows data completeness gauge.

BQ-ORG ★ NEW

Which organizations generate the most parking demand?

Extracts email domain from ownerEmail, groups by org, shows ranked bar + doughnut chart



6. Full Eventual Connectivity Scenario Table

Wiki documentation reference

FEATURE	OFFLINE SCENARIO	EXPECTED RESPONSE (UX / SYSTEM)	IMPLEMENTATION
Authentication	Login attempt while offline	Display "Offline Mode: Using last saved session." Allow entry via Biometrics (Face ID/ Touch ID) if a local profile cache exists.	LAContext.evaluatePolicy(local). Firebase session token persists in Keychain.
Vehicle Management	User adds a new car while offline	Update local @Published state immediately. Queue Firestore sync in PendingActionsQueue. Show "Syncing/Offline" icon.	addRecord(isOffline: true) FileManager JSON queue
Map & Navigation	Signal loss during transit	Retain last calculated route. If map tiles fail, show compass-based UI with last known coordinates.	NavigationManager caches lastRouteCalculationLocation MapKit tiles cached by OS
Spot Occupancy	User marks a spot as "Occupied" but network fails	Mark spot as "Pending Confirmation" locally. Notify user: "Your reservation will sync once connection is restored."	addRecord(isOffline: true) pendingActionsCount badge Dashboard
Real-Time Monitor	Parking availability data cannot be fetched	Display "Data from [Timestamp]." Disable "Live" badge. Show cached occupancy from NSCache.	SpotCacheManager serves known spots. Orange offline banner shows.

FEATURE	OFFLINE SCENARIO	EXPECTED RESPONSE (UX / SYSTEM)	IMPLEMENTATION
AI Recommendations	User requests a Gemini tip while offline	Skip live SDK call. Show "OFFLINE" badge. Serve locally computed briefing from cached Firestore data.	GerenteSummaryView checks networkMonitor.isConnected before Task { model.generateContent()
Manager: Traffic Flow	Manager registers entry/exit in basement with no signal	Record event with local timestamp. Add to PendingActionsQueue (FileManager). Syncs automatically when connection is restored.	PendingActionsQueue.enqueue() → syncPendingActions() on reconnect
Profile Cache	First-time app open with no internet	Show ContentUnavailableView: "Initial connection required to set up your profile."	fetchUserData() fails gracefully; isLoggedIn stays false; LoginView shown.
Parking History	User opens My History while offline	Show "Showing cached history — live updates paused" banner. Records served from Firestore listener in-memory cache.	Firestore listener retains last 100 records in memory. MyHistoryView reads from vm.vehicleRecords.



7. Architecture Overview

New files + modified files in Sprint 3

New files created in Sprint 3

FILE	LOCATION	PURPOSE	RUBRIC
NetworkMonitor.swift	Core/	NWPathMonitor wrapper. Publishes	Eventual Conn.

FILE	LOCATION	PURPOSE	RUBRIC
		isConnected Bool via @MainActor @Published. Shared as @EnvironmentObject.	
SpotCacheManager.swift	Core/	NSCache<NSString, NSArray> singleton. Stores [ParkingSpot] by floor with countLimit=500 and totalCostLimit=2MB.	Caching
PendingActionsQueue.swift	Core/	FileManager JSON queue for offline parking actions. Atomic writes. Drained by syncPendingActions() on reconnect.	Local Storage

Modified files in Sprint 3

FILE	CHANGE
sd_smart_parkingApp.swift	Added @StateObject NetworkMonitor, passed as .environmentObject to ContentView
ContentView.swift	Added @EnvironmentObject NetworkMonitor, .onChange triggers syncPendingActions() on reconnect, loadInitialDataParallel() in .task
ParkingViewModel.swift	Added: pendingActionsCount @Published, loadInitialDataParallel() with withTaskGroup, prewarmSpotsCache() + prewarmRecordsCache(), syncPendingActions(), addRecord(isOffline:) with FileManager

FILE	CHANGE
	queuing, NSCache write in listenToSpots()
DashboardView.swift	Added @EnvironmentObject NetworkMonitor, offline orange banner with pending count badge
SpotsView.swift	Added @EnvironmentObject NetworkMonitor, offline banner with "changes queued" message
GerenteSummaryView.swift	Added @EnvironmentObject NetworkMonitor, offline AI badge, generateBriefing() checks isConnected before Gemini call
MyHistoryView.swift	Added @EnvironmentObject NetworkMonitor, "cached history" banner when offline
analytics-dashboard.html	Added BQ-ORG section: CSS styles, HTML placeholder, JS computation of org clients by email domain, bar chart + doughnut chart

Summary for the viva voce — what to show and say

EXAMINER ASKS ABOUT...	SHOW...	SAY...
Caching	SpotCacheManager.swift	"We use NSCache which is thread-safe and implements LRU-like eviction. countLimit caps object count at 500; totalCostLimit enforces a 2 MB budget by assigning a per-object cost at write time via setObject(_:forKey:cost:)."

EXAMINER ASKS ABOUT...	SHOW...	SAY...
Concurrency	<code>loadInitialDataParallel()</code> in <code>ParkingViewModel</code>	"withTaskGroup spawns two concurrent background I/O tasks simultaneously. The group suspends until both finish, then <code>MainActor.run</code> dispatches the UI update to the main thread — this is the iOS equivalent of multiple coroutines with I/O and main dispatchers."
Local Storage	<code>@AppStorage</code> + <code>PendingActionsQueue.swift</code>	"We use two strategies: <code>UserDefaults</code> via <code>@AppStorage</code> for the biometric preference boolean, and <code>FileManager</code> JSON for the offline action queue. Atomic writes prevent corruption on crash. <code>JSONEncoder</code> with ISO8601 dates ensures the file is human-readable and portable."
Eventual Connectivity	Toggle airplane mode → all 5 views show banners	" <code>NWPathMonitor</code> detects connectivity on a background queue and dispatches updates to <code>@MainActor</code> . Each view has its own specific offline behavior — no global splash screen. On reconnect, <code>syncPendingActions()</code> replays the <code>FileManager</code> queue to <code>Firestore</code> automatically."

**EXAMINER
ASKS
ABOUT...**

SHOW...

SAY...

analytics-dashboard.html
BQ-ORG section

"We query vehicleRecords filtered by date range from Firestore, extract the email domain from ownerEmail, and group by organization. This answers which institution generates the most parking demand — informing reserved-spot allocation decisions."